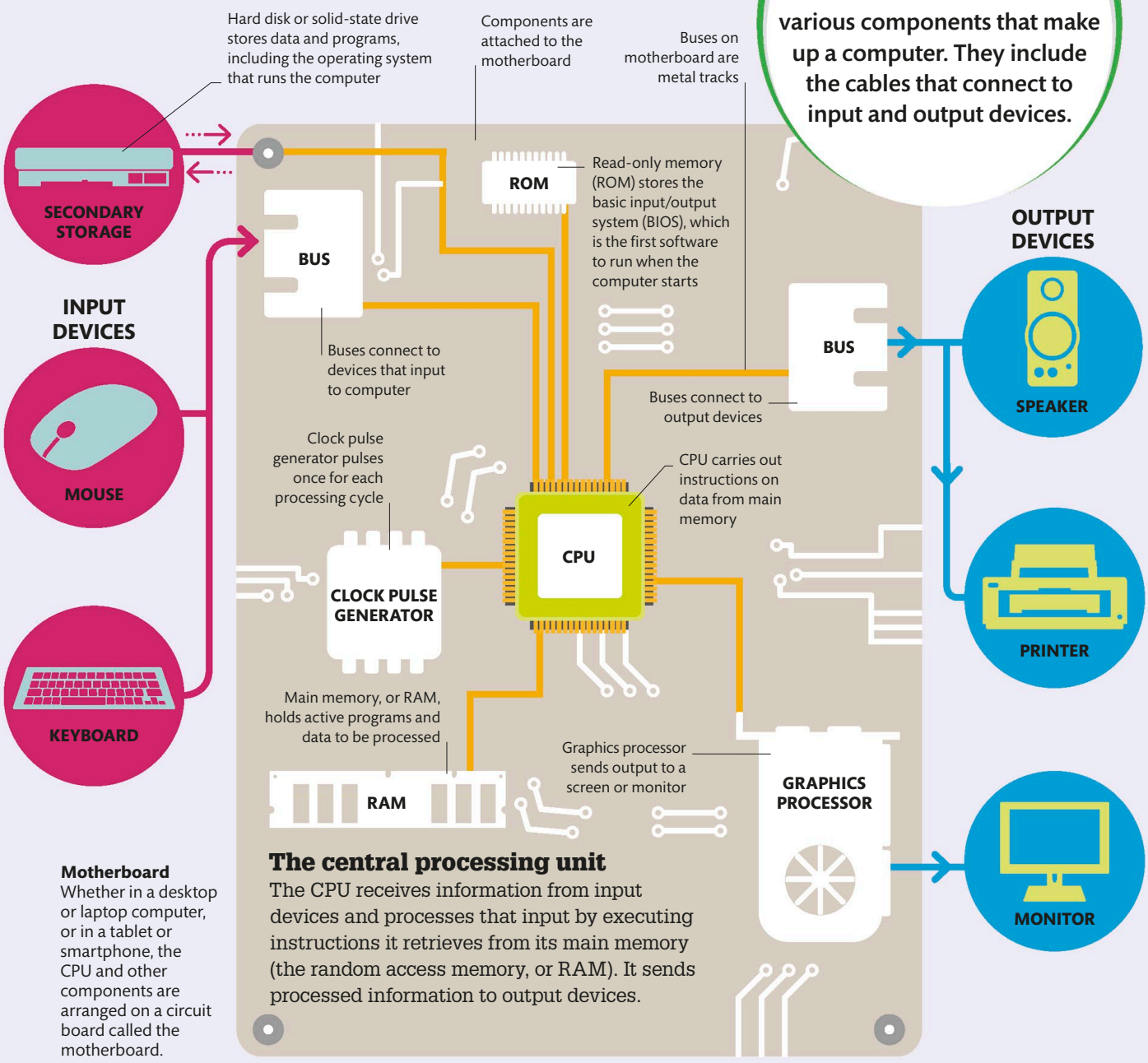
How computers work

At the heart of every computer is an integrated circuit called the central processing unit (CPU). It communicates with the computer's main memory, input devices, and output devices.

WHAT IS A BUS?

In computing, buses are the connections between the various components that make up a computer. They include the cables that connect to input and output devices.



The central processing unit

The CPU receives information from input devices and processes that input by executing instructions it retrieves from its main memory (the random access memory, or RAM). It sends processed information to output devices.

Motherboard
Whether in a desktop or laptop computer, or in a tablet or smartphone, the CPU and other components are arranged on a circuit board called the motherboard.